

CHRISTOPHER JUNKER

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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer, eight years on payments, partner integrations, and data platforms. Led an 8-person team at 2U and owned our AWS infrastructure in Terraform. Ruby, Python, and Go. I work with AI tooling daily and measure what it produces before trusting it.

SKILLS

Ruby, Python, Go, TypeScript, SQL | Rails, React, Celery, Tornado | PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch | AWS (EC2, Lambda, S3, RDS, ElastiCache, DocumentDB, IAM, Secrets Manager, SQS/SNS, CloudWatch, Route 53, VPC), Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker, Cloudflare, Linux | Kafka, Datadog, PagerDuty | System Design, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Payments/PCI, Third-Party Integrations | LLM evaluation, agentic workflows, AI-assisted development | Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, TDD, Agile

EXPERIENCE

Independent Software Consultant

Apr 2026 – Present

- Sole engineer on a contracted iOS pilot for a physical therapy practice. Built the Expo and React Native app with on-device SQLite, plus the Rails backend and clinician dashboard the pilot is read from. Sync is opt-in and check-ins carry a participant code, so the server holds no names or contact details. Built an SMS version as well, then dropped it once 10DLC registration turned out to take 10 to 15 days against about a day for TestFlight review.
- Wrote the randomized prompt scheduling and missed-prompt reconciliation the pilot's data comes from. Every prompt records both its planned and actual delivery time, so late ones can be filtered out of the analysis.

2U

Brooklyn, NY

Senior Software Engineer

Aug 2022 – Apr 2026

- Led an 8-person team (2 FTEs, 6 contractors) across three production systems: a multi-tenant Rails CRM, a Python data platform serving 70+ university partners, and payment routing across 4 providers. Onboarded and mentored 8 engineers.
- Built PCI-compliant secrets rotation on AWS Secrets Manager, covering 100+ credentials across payments, partner integrations, and internal APIs, with validation before every cutover.
- Owned the team's AWS footprint in Terraform: Cloudflare edge, Route 53 delegation, VPC, self-managed Kubernetes on EC2, RDS, ElastiCache, DocumentDB, SQS/SNS, Lambda, IAM, and Secrets Manager. Wrote our service modules on top of base modules the DevOps org maintained.
- Ran architecture reviews across product, engineering, and third-party integrations. Wrote the SLAs and cardholder-data-environment diagrams, and worked with Security and SRE on shared tooling and compliance.
- Replaced manual partner data exports with a Python and Celery service running 350+ scheduled jobs, tuning batch queries over 1B+ records with Redis caching and connection pooling. Ran 70+ Lambda functions under isolated IAM roles for FERPA-covered transfers.
- Joined 2U's company-wide Claude pilot and brought AI-assisted development and epic planning to the team.
- Owned reliability for all three systems: Datadog dashboards and CloudWatch alerts that caught regressions within 5 minutes, SLA monitoring, incident response, postmortems, and primary PagerDuty rotation.
- Cut CI runtime from 105 to 16 minutes by parallelizing the suite and reworking test infrastructure. Led the Ruby 2.7 to 3.2 and Rails 5 to 7 upgrades, deployed with no downtime.
- Set S3 lifecycle policies with tiered IAM permissions for sensitive document retention and database backups.

Software Engineer

Aug 2018 – Jul 2022

- Migrated 4B+ records across 13 tables from Python and MongoDB to Rails and MySQL with no downtime, remodeling document data into a relational schema. The ETL was idempotent and recovered from partial failures; schema changes ran live with the Percona toolkit.
- Built a throttled ETL API with rate limiting, cursor pagination, and structured logging so partner data syncs could not saturate downstream services.
- Added Elasticsearch indexing for full-text search, replacing SQL queries that had grown too slow.

PROJECTS

- **Nitpick**, an AI code-review GitHub App (Go, async webhook processing, bring-your-own-LLM). Benchmarked models against a labeled set of PRs before picking a default: Sonnet 4.6 scored F1 0.46 at \$0.029 per PR, Haiku 4.5 scored 0.25 at \$0.007. Prompted to stay quiet unless confident. github.com/cjunks94/nitpick
- **Panoptrain**, a live NYC subway map (TypeScript, React 19, Hono, MapLibre). Polls MTA GTFS-RT feeds and interpolates train positions between updates, with trip planning via Dijkstra and Yen's k-shortest paths. Running at panoptrain.cjunker.dev. github.com/cjunks94/panoptrain

EDUCATION

Villanova University, B.S. Computer Science (Minor: Business)
Flatiron School, Full-Stack Web Development Immersion